QF5204 Numerical Methods in Quantitative Finance

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Lecture 1

Numerical Methods in the Financial Industry Numerical methods play a critical role in modeling, analyzing, and solving complex problems in finance, especially when analytical solutions are infeasible. They are widely applied in risk management, derivative pricing, portfolio optimization, and market simulation.

Key Applications Option pricing and hedging, risk management, portfolio optimization, fixed-income analytics, algorithmic trading.

What Is a Numerical Method A numerical method focuses on obtaining approximate solutions to mathematical problems when exact, closed-form solutions are unavailable or impractical.

Main Components

- Theoretical development of numerical schemes
- Practical implementation as efficient and reliable algorithms

How Numerical Methods Work Simplify complex problems to tractable approximations and solve them numerically. These methods rely on tools from linear algebra, real analysis, and functional analysis. A central focus is understanding and controlling error, including error magnitude, analytical bounds, efficiency, and computational cost.

Core Considerations

- **Accuracy:** ensuring results are precise and reliable
- **Computational cost:** balancing efficiency with time and resource constraints

Python Toolbox

- Packages: numpy, scipy, matplotlib, pandas, statsmodels, quandl, matplotlib
- Techniques: Reshaping, reference vs copy, j for complex number, indexing and slicing, upcasting, broadcasting, vectorization, lambda expressions.
- Practices: Modularization and organization, error handling, computational cost estimation

Errors in Numerical Methods Numerical methods produce approximate solutions when analytical solutions are unavailable, making error analysis central to reliability.

Types of Errors

- **Modeling error:** mismatch between physical reality and simplified mathematical model
- **Truncation error:** approximation of infinite processes by finite ones
- **Round-off error:** finite precision limitations in computer arithmetic

Approximation Pipeline

- Problem $\to$ mathematical model (modeling error)
- Model $\to$ numerical method (truncation error)
- Method $\to$ computation (rounding error)

Numerical Error Measures

- **True error:** $E_t = \text{true value} - \text{approximation}$
- **Relative error:** $\dfrac{E_t}{\text{true value}}$
- **Relative error percentage:** $\dfrac{E_t}{\text{true value}} \times 100\%$

Binary Number Representation Computers use binary representations composed of bits $\{0, 1\}$

- Positive integer:

$$d_n d_{n-1} \cdots d_0 = \sum_{i=0}^{n} d_i 2^i$$

- Fractional number:

$$d_{-1} d_{-2} \cdots d_{-m} = \sum_{i=1}^{m} d_{-i} 2^{-i}$$

Integer Ranges (32-bit) Unsigned: $[0, 2^{32} - 1]$; Signed: $[-2^{31}, 2^{31} - 1]$

Fixed-Point Representation

- Binary point is fixed at a predefined position
- Defined by width w and binary point position b
- Denoted as $\text{fixed}\langle w, b\rangle$; Integer type: $\text{fixed}\langle 32, 0\rangle$
- Limited range $\Rightarrow$ overflow error when exceeded

Fixed-Point Value Formula

For $\text{fixed}\langle w, b\rangle$ with bits $d_{w-1} \cdots d_0$:

$$x = \begin{cases} \displaystyle\sum_{k=0}^{w-2} d_k 2^{k-b}, & \text{if } d_{w-1} = 0 \quad \text{(positive real number)}, \\ & \text{e.g., } 0111_2 \text{ in } \text{fixed}\langle 4, 1\rangle : \ x = 2 + 1 + 0.5 = 3.5, \\ \displaystyle -2^{w-1-b} + \sum_{k=0}^{w-2} d_k 2^{k-b}, & \text{if } d_{w-1} = 1 \quad \text{(negative real number)}, \\ & \text{e.g., } 1011_2 \text{ in } \text{fixed}\langle 4, 1\rangle : \ x = -4 + 1 + 0.5 = -2.5 \end{cases}$$

Floating-Point Representation (IEEE 754) Binary scientific notation

- Structure: sign bit, exponent bits, significand bits
- Value:

$$(-1)^s (1 + \text{significand}) 2^{\text{exponent} - \text{bias}} \text{(e.g.} 1.01 \times 2^{-1}, \ 1{,}01 \text{ Significand; -1 Exponent)}$$

Floating-Point Ranges 32-bit float: $\approx 10^{-38}$ to 10^{38}; 64-bit float: $\approx 10^{-308}$ to 10^{308}

Numerical Errors Definitions

- True error: $E_t = \text{True value} - \text{Approximation}$
- Relative error: $E_r = \dfrac{|E_t|}{|\text{True value}|}$
- Relative error percentage: $\%\ \text{error} = E_r \times 100\%$

Number Representation and Range

- **Binary representation:** integers use bits $d_n \cdots d_0$ with value $\sum_{k=0}^{n} d_k 2^k$.
- **32-bit integer ranges:** unsigned $[0, 2^{32} - 1]$, signed $[-2^{31}, 2^{31} - 1]$.
- **Fixed-point:** type $\text{fixed}\langle w, b\rangle$ has width w and binary point at position b; limited range $\Rightarrow$ overflow possible.
- **Floating-point:** scientific notation in base 2 (IEEE 754); wide dynamic range. Typical ranges: 32-bit float $\approx 10^{-38}$ to 10^{38}, 64-bit float $\approx 10^{-308}$ to 10^{308}.

Rounding Error Effects

- Errors accumulate gradually across computations
- Subtracting nearly equal numbers causes catastrophic cancellation
- Adding numbers of very different magnitudes causes loss of precision

Machine Epsilon

- Machine epsilon ε is the smallest number such that $1 + \varepsilon \neq 1$ in machine arithmetic.
- It quantifies round-off effects and depends on hardware/precision.

Truncation Error (Taylor-based) Truncation error comes from dropping higher-order terms.

$$f(x + h) = f(x) + hf'(x) + \frac{h^2}{2} f''(x) + \cdots$$

$$f(x) = f(a) + f'(a)(x - a) + \cdots + \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}(x - a)^n + R_n(x), \qquad R_n(x) = \frac{f^{(n+1)}(c)}{(n + 1)!}(x - a)^{n+1}.$$

Local vs. Global Truncation Error

- **Local truncation error:** error introduced in one step; for first-order Taylor,

$$f(x + h) = f(x) + hf'(x) + O(h^2), \quad \Rightarrow \text{local error } = O(h^2).$$

- A method has order p if local truncation error is $O(h^{p+1})$.
- **Global truncation error:** accumulation over K steps with $\Delta h = h/K$:

$$e_K \approx K \cdot O(\Delta h^2) = \frac{h}{\Delta h} O(\Delta h^2) = O(h\Delta h).$$

- Convergent methods satisfy global error $\to 0$ as $\Delta h \to 0$.

Convergence and Rate

- $\{x_k\}$ converges to x^* if $\lim_{k\to\infty} x_k = x^*$.
- With error $e_k = |x_k - x^*|$, order p if

$$\lim_{k\to\infty} \frac{|e_{k+1}|}{|e_k|^p} = c_0.$$

Common Convergence Behaviors

- **Linear ($p = 1$):** $\|x_{k+1} - x^*\| \le c_0 \|x_k - x^*\|, \ 0 < c_0 < 1$.
- **Sub-linear:** Logarithmic Convergence: $\|x_k - x^*\| = O(1/\log k)$ or Polynomial Convergence: $O(1/k^p)$.
- **Super-linear:** $\dfrac{\|x_{k+1} - x^*\|}{\|x_k - x^*\|} \to 0$.
- **Quadratic ($p = 2$):** $\dfrac{\|x_{k+1} - x^*\|}{\|x_k - x^*\|^2} = c_0$

Tolerance and Stopping Criteria

- True error requires knowing the true value:

$$E_t = \text{True value} - \text{Approximation}.$$

- In practice, the true value is unknown, so we use tolerance-based tests to decide when an iterate is "close enough".

Typical tests (tolerance ε_0) Choice of test depends on the application (scaling, units, noise sensitivity).

- **Absolute change:** $|x_{k+1} - x_k| \le \varepsilon_0$.
- **Relative change:** $\dfrac{|x_{k+1} - x_k|}{|x_k|} \le \varepsilon_0$.

Lecture 2

The Time Value of Money

- An amount x invested at interest rate r grows to $x(1 + r) = x + xr$, where x is the principal and xr is the interest.
- With continuous compounding for n years, the value becomes xe^{rn}.
- A *fixed-income security* provides a predetermined stream of cash flows.
- *Annuities*: pay a fixed amount A at the end of every period indefinitely.
- *Bonds*: pay a face (par) value at a specified maturity time.

Introduction to Forward Contracts

- A *derivative* is a security whose payoff depends on another variable.
- A *forward contract* fixes today the price of an asset delivered at future time T.
- Two times are fixed: 0 (today) and T (delivery). $F(0, T)$ denotes the forward price agreed upon today.
- *Long position*: agree to buy at T for $F(0, T)$.
- *Short position*: agree to sell at T for $F(0, T)$.

No-Arbitrage Condition in Forward Pricing

- Arbitrage arises if the forward price deviates from its fair theoretical value.
- *Cash-and-carry arbitrage* (forward overpriced): borrow at rate r, buy spot asset at S, short the forward, profit $F - Se^{rT}$.
- *Reverse cash-and-carry* (forward underpriced): short the asset, invest proceeds, go long the forward, profit $Se^{rT} - F$.
- No-arbitrage implies the cost-of-carry formula $F = Se^{rT}$.

Dynamic (Tree-Based) Models

- Discrete-time price dynamics are commonly modeled using trees.
- Asset values evolve multiplicatively: $S \to uS$ (up) or dS (down).
- Constants u and d are fixed multipliers.
- Let p be the probability of an up move and $1 - p$ of a down move.

Binomial Tree Parameters

- Define yearly expected growth rate and volatility:

$$\mu = \mathbb{E}[\ln(S(1)/S(0))], \quad \sigma = \sqrt{\mathrm{Var}(\ln(S(1)/S(0)))}.$$

- Choose parameters: Let Δt be the time step (typically a day or a week). We model the log-price increment over one time step Δt by a binomial move:

$$\log \frac{S_{t+\Delta t}}{S_t} = \begin{cases} \log u, & \text{with probability } p, \\ \log d, & \text{with probability } 1-p. \end{cases}$$

Choose symmetric up/down factors

$$u = e^{\sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}}, \quad d = e^{-\sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}} \quad \Rightarrow \quad \log u = \sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}, \quad \log d = -\sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}.$$

The expected log-return is then

$$\mathbb{E}\left[\log \frac{S_{t+\Delta t}}{S_t}\right] = p \log u + (1-p)\log d = (2p-1)\sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}.$$

To match the drift μ of the continuous-time log-price,

$$\mathbb{E}\left[\log \frac{S_{t+\Delta t}}{S_t}\right] \approx \mu\,\Delta t \Rightarrow (2p-1)\sigma\sqrt{\Delta t} = \mu\,\Delta t.$$

Solving for p yields

$$p = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2}\frac{\mu}{\sigma}\sqrt{\Delta t}.$$

General Discrete-Time Models

- Consider the multiplicative model

$$S(k+1) = u(k)S(k),$$

where $\{u(k)\}$ are independent random variables.
- Taking logarithms,

$$\ln S(k+1) = \ln S(k) + \ln u(k).$$

- If $X \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$, then $Y = e^X$ is lognormally distributed:

$$Y \sim LN(\mu, \sigma^2), \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbb{E}[Y] = e^{\mu+\sigma^2/2}.$$

- In particular, in a lognormal multiplicative model with $u(k) \sim LN(\nu, \sigma^2)$, the log-returns satisfy

$$\mathbb{E}\left[\ln \frac{S(k+1)}{S(k)}\right] = \mathbb{E}[\ln u(k)] = \nu \quad \mathrm{Var}\left[\ln \frac{S(k+1)}{S(k)}\right] = \mathrm{Var}[\ln u(k)] = \sigma^2.$$

Random Walks and Wiener Process

- Discrete stochastic process:

$$z(t_{k+1}) = z(t_k) + \epsilon(t_k)\sqrt{\Delta t}, \quad \epsilon(t_k) \sim \mathcal{N}(0,1).$$

- As $\Delta t \to 0$, $z(t)$ converges to the Wiener process:

$$dz(t) = \epsilon(t)\sqrt{dt}.$$

- Properties of Brownian motion: $z(0) = 0$, continuous paths,

$$z(t) - z(s) \sim \mathcal{N}(0, t-s), \quad t > s.$$

Ito Process and Geometric Brownian Motion

- Wiener process with drift:

$$dx(t) = a\,dt + b\,dz(t), \quad a, b \in \mathbb{R}.$$

- Integral form:

$$x(t) = x(0) + at + bz(t).$$

- General Ito process:

$$dx(t) = a(t)\,dt + b(t)\,dz(t).$$

- Geometric Brownian motion (GBM) for stock prices:

$$dS(t) = \mu S(t)\,dt + \sigma S(t)\,dz(t).$$

Ito's Lemma

- Let $x(t)$ follow an Ito process and $G(x,t)$ be a smooth function.
- Taylor expansion (ignoring higher-order terms):

$$\Delta G = \frac{\partial G}{\partial x}\Delta x + \frac{\partial G}{\partial t}\Delta t + \frac{1}{2}\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial x^2}(\Delta x)^2.$$

- With $\Delta x = a\Delta t + b\epsilon\sqrt{\Delta t}$, $\epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0,1)$ and $\mathbb{E}[\epsilon^2] = 1$,
- Taking limits yields Ito's lemma:

$$\Delta G = \frac{\partial G}{\partial x}\Delta x + \frac{\partial G}{\partial t}\Delta t + \frac{1}{2}\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial x^2}b^2\epsilon^2\Delta t \quad \Rightarrow \quad \Delta G = \frac{\partial G}{\partial x}\Delta x + \frac{\partial G}{\partial t}\Delta t + \frac{1}{2}\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial x^2}b^2\Delta t$$

Ito's Lemma for Stock Prices

- Taking limits, for a function $G(x,t)$:

$$dG = \frac{\partial G}{\partial x}\,dx + \frac{\partial G}{\partial t}\,dt + \frac{1}{2}\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial x^2}b^2\,dt.$$

- Substituting $dx = a\,dt + b\,dz$, we obtain Ito's lemma:

$$dG = \left(\frac{\partial G}{\partial x}a + \frac{\partial G}{\partial t} + \frac{1}{2}\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial x^2}b^2\right)dt + \frac{\partial G}{\partial x}b\,dz.$$

- Application to the stock price process:

$$dS = \mu S\,dt + \sigma S\,dz.$$

- For a function $G(S,t)$:

$$dG = \left(\frac{\partial G}{\partial S}\mu S + \frac{\partial G}{\partial t} + \frac{1}{2}\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial S^2}\sigma^2 S^2\right)dt + \frac{\partial G}{\partial S}\sigma S\,dz.$$

Options

- An option is a financial contract whose value depends on an underlying asset.
- The holder has the right, but not the obligation, to trade at a fixed price.
- Strike price: K, maturity time: T.
- Call option: right to buy at time T for price K.
- Put option: right to sell at time T for price K.
- Payoffs at maturity:

$$\text{Call: } \max(S_T - K, 0), \qquad \text{Put: } \max(K - S_T, 0).$$

- Derivative payoff is a function of the underlying: $X = F(S_T)$.

Option Strategies

- Option strategies combine basic options to create desired payoffs.
- Strangle: buy a put at K_1 and a call at $K_2 > K_1$.
- Straddle: special case of strangle with $K_1 = K_2$.
- Bull spread: buy call at K_1, sell call at $K_2 > K_1$.
- Bear spread: sell put at K_1, buy put at $K_2 > K_1$.

Option Moneyness

- Moneyness describes the relation between stock price S and strike K.
- In-the-Money (ITM): option has positive intrinsic value if exercised now.
- At-the-Money (ATM): $S \approx K$.
- Out-of-the-Money (OTM): option has zero intrinsic value if exercsised.

Financial Derivatives

- A financial derivative is a contract whose value depends on an underlying asset (stocks, bonds, commodities).
- Types of derivatives:
  - Vanilla options: standardized, simple payoff structures.
  - Exotic options: complex features and conditions.
- Linear products include forwards, futures, and swaps.
- **Law of One Price**: identical assets must have the same price in frictionless markets.

European Options and Black–Scholes Model

- European options may only be exercised at expiry.
- Priced analytically using the Black–Scholes model.
- Assumptions:
  - No arbitrage opportunities.
  - Constant risk-free interest rate.
  - Log-normal distribution of underlying prices.
  - No dividends.
  - Frictionless markets.

Pricing Exotic Options

- Exotic options have complex or path-dependent payoffs.
- Examples:
  - American options: exercisable anytime before expiry.
  - Barrier options: activated when price hits a barrier.
  - Asian options: payoff depends on average price.
- Analytical pricing may fail due to complexity.
- Numerical approaches:
  - Binomial tree models.
  - Monte Carlo simulation.
  - Finite difference methods.

Binomial Tree Model

- Discrete-time model for option pricing.
- Asset price moves up or down at each step.
- Proposed by Cox, Ross, and Rubinstein (1979).
- Advantages: simple, applicable to European and American options.

One-Step Binomial Model

- Time interval $[0, T]$ with two possible states at T.
- Initial stock price: S_0.
- Up state: $S_u = uS_0$, with probability p.
- Down state: $S_d = dS_0$, with probability $1 - p$.
- Risk-free interest rate: r.

Pricing by Replication

- Portfolio consists of δ shares of stock and cash B.
- Initial value:
$$V_0 = \delta S_0 + B.$$
- Replication conditions:
$$\delta S_u + e^{rT} B = V_u, \quad \delta S_d + e^{rT} B = V_d.$$

Option Payoffs

- Call option:
$$V_u = \max(S_u - K, 0), \quad V_d = \max(S_d - K, 0).$$
- Put option:
$$V_u = \max(K - S_u, 0), \quad V_d = \max(K - S_d, 0).$$

Solving the Linear System

- Hedge ratio:
$$\delta = \frac{V_u - V_d}{S_u - S_d}.$$
- Cash position:
$$B = e^{-rT}(V_u - \delta S_u).$$
- Option price:
$$V_0 = e^{-rT}(q_u V_u + q_d V_d),$$
where
$$q_u = \frac{S_0 e^{rT} - S_d}{S_u - S_d}, \quad q_d = \frac{S_u - S_0 e^{rT}}{S_u - S_d}.$$

Implementation

- Inputs:
  - Stock price S_0, interest rate r.
  - Up/down factors u, d.
  - Option type, strike K, maturity T.
- Output: option price.
- One-step binomial pricing demonstrated for call and put.
- In practice, u and d are chosen using volatility σ.

Is the Binomial Tree Model Still Useful?

- The binomial tree is a simplified, step-by-step framework for understanding option price evolution.
- It provides a discretized approximation of the continuous Black–Scholes model.
- It avoids explicitly fixing S_u and S_d by linking them to volatility σ.
- Stock prices are viewed as following a continuous stochastic process (GBM).

Intuition Behind Black–Scholes

- Stock prices evolve continuously rather than via discrete up/down jumps.
- Two driving components:
  - Drift: average rate of return.
  - Randomness: market uncertainty (volatility).

Black–Scholes Model

- Under the risk-neutral measure, the stock price satisfies
$$dS_t = S_t(r\,dt + \sigma\,dW_t), \qquad \frac{dS_t}{S_t} = r\,dt + \sigma\,dW_t.$$
- Parameters:
  - r: risk-free interest rate,
  - σ: volatility,
  - W_t: standard Brownian motion.
- Assumptions: continuous trading, constant r and σ.

Solution of the Stock Price SDE

- Applying Itô's lemma to $f(S_t) = \ln S_t$:
$$d\ln S_t = \left(r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)dt + \sigma\,dW_t.$$
- Hence,
$$S_t = S_0 \exp\left(\left(r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)t + \sigma W_t\right), \quad W_t \sim \mathcal{N}(0, t).$$

Black–Scholes Option Pricing

- Call option price at time 0:
$$C(S_0, K, T) = e^{-rT}\mathbb{E}_Q[(S_T - K)_+].$$
- Defining
$$d_\pm = \frac{\ln(S_0/K) + (r \pm \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2)T}{\sigma\sqrt{T}},$$
the closed-form solution is
$$C(S_0, K, T) = S_0 N(d_+) - Ke^{-rT}N(d_-).$$
- Corresponding put price:
$$P(S_0, K, T) = Ke^{-rT}N(-d_-) - S_0 N(-d_+).$$

Binomial vs. Black–Scholes at Maturity

- Binomial tree: two-point discrete distribution for S_T vs Black–Scholes: continuous lognormal distribution.
- Both models share the same mean:
$$\mathbb{E}[S_T] = S_0 e^{rT}.$$
- Variances differ, but converge as the tree is refined.

Matching the Variance of Two

- One-step binomial model:
$$S_u = uS_0, \quad S_d = dS_0, \quad u > 1,\ 0 < d < 1.$$
- Variance of binomial tree:
$$\mathrm{Var}(S_T) = S_0^2\left(pu^2 + (1-p)d^2\right) - S_0^2 e^{2rT}.$$
- Variance under Black–Scholes:
$$\mathrm{Var}(S_T) = S_0^2 e^{2rT}\left(e^{\sigma^2 T} - 1\right).$$
- Matching variances requires
$$e^{2rT + \sigma^2 T} = pu^2 + (1-p)d^2.$$
- CRR assumption:
$$d = \frac{1}{u}.$$

Risk-Neutral Probability

- No-arbitrage condition:
$$pu + (1-p)d = e^{rT}.$$
- Risk-neutral probability:
$$p = \frac{e^{rT} - 1/u}{u - 1/u}.$$

Solving for u

- Substitution gives:
$$e^{2rT + \sigma^2 T} = e^{rT}\left(u + \frac{1}{u}\right) - 1.$$
- Quadratic equation:
$$u^2 - \left(e^{rT + \sigma^2 T} + e^{-rT}\right)u + 1 = 0.$$
- Roots:
$$u = \frac{b + \sqrt{b^2 - 4}}{2}, \quad d = \frac{b - \sqrt{b^2 - 4}}{2},$$
where $b = e^{rT + \sigma^2 T} + e^{-rT}$.

Bringing It Closer

- One-step variance matching does not fully replicate Black–Scholes.
- Binomial model approximates a continuous stochastic process.
- Accuracy improves by increasing time steps.

Multi-Step Binomial Tree

- Divide $[0, T]$ into N steps with $\Delta t = T/N$.
- State probabilities:
$$p(S_{N,i}) = \binom{N}{i} p^i (1-p)^{N-i}.$$
- Recombining tree ensures polynomial growth of nodes.

Moments of S_T

- First moment:
$$\mathbb{E}[S_T \mid S_0] = S_0(pu + (1-p)d)^N.$$
- Second moment:
$$\mathbb{E}[S_T^2 \mid S_0] = S_0^2(pu^2 + (1-p)d^2)^N.$$

N-Step Matching with Black–Scholes

- Risk-neutral probability:
$$p = \frac{e^{r\Delta t} - d}{u - d}.$$
- Mean matching:
$$\mathbb{E}[S_T \mid S_0] = S_0 e^{rT}.$$
- Variance matching:
$$u = \frac{b + \sqrt{b^2 - 4}}{2e^{r\Delta t}}, \quad d = \frac{1}{u}, \quad \text{where} \quad b = e^{(2r + \sigma^2)\Delta t} + 1.$$
- As $N \to \infty$, S_T converges to a log-normal distribution.

Lecture 3

What's the Next Step?

- European calls/puts and digitals are not the only tradable products. Other products of interest include European options with generic payoff, American options, Barrier options. etc.
- Many products have no closed-form solutions, and Binomial tree pricer can handle these cases.
- Goal: refine implementation to be easier to maintain and extend.

American Options

- At each node, compute the continuation value via conditional expectation.
- American options allow early exercise at any node.
- Two quantities at each node:
  - Intrinsic value:
$$\max(S-K,0)\ \text{(Call)}, \qquad \max(K-S,0)\ \text{(Put)}.$$
  - Continuation value: expected discounted future payoff.
- Decision rule:
$$V(t) = \max(\text{Intrinsic Value},\ \text{Continuation Value}).$$

Optimal Exercise Strategy

- Continue holding if continuation value exceeds intrinsic value.
- Exercise immediately if intrinsic value exceeds continuation value.
- At every node, maximize the option value.

Refining Code Structure

- Modify European pricer `n_step_binomial_tree`.
- At each iteration: continuation value (no exercise), payoff value (immediate exercise)
- Avoid copy–paste; improve extensibility.
- Allow flexible payoff definitions.

First-Step Extension

- Encapsulate tradable instrument parameters.
- European options:
  - expiry T, strike K, payoff type
- American options:
  - European features
  - early exercise capability

Tree Algorithm (American Option)

- Initialize terminal payoff.
- Backward induction for $k = N-1, \dots, 0$:
  - Compute discounted continuation value.
  - Compute option value from payoff and continuation.
- Step 5: tree pricer.
- Step 6: product-specific payoff rule.

Call Spread

- Strategy: buy and sell calls with different strikes.
- Bull call spread:
  - Buy call at lower strike K_{low}.
  - Sell call at higher strike K_{high}.
- Risk: limited to total premium paid.
- Reward: capped at $K_{\text{high}} - K_{\text{low}}$ minus cost.

Barrier Options

- Payoff depends on whether the underlying hits a barrier.
- Defined by:
  - one or two barriers (up/down),
  - monitoring window (usually $[0,T]$).
- Knock-In (KI): option becomes active only if barrier is hit.
- Knock-Out (KO): option expires if barrier is hit.
- Underlying payoff:
  - European payoff, or
  - fixed rebate (touch option).

Barrier Options Example (1): Up-and-In Call

- Strike price: $K = 100$
- Barrier level: $B = 120$
- Option premium: \$6

Payoff Scenarios

- Barrier touched, $S_T = 130$:
$$\text{Payoff} = 30, \quad \text{Net Profit} = 24$$
- Barrier not touched, $S_T = 130$:
$$\text{Payoff} = 0, \quad \text{Net Profit} = -6$$
- Barrier touched, $S_T = 95$:
$$\text{Payoff} = 0, \quad \text{Net Profit} = -6$$

Motivation

- Lower premium than vanilla call due to conditional activation.
- Useful when exposure is desired only after breaching a price level.

Barrier Options Example (2): Up-and-Out Call

- Strike price: $K = 100$
- Barrier level: $B = 120$
- Option premium: \$8

Payoff Outcomes

- Barrier not touched, $S_T = 110$:
$$\text{Payoff} = 10, \quad \text{Net Profit} = 2$$
- Barrier touched at any time:
$$\text{Payoff} = 0, \quad \text{Net Profit} = -8$$
- $S_T < 100$:
$$\text{Payoff} = 0, \quad \text{Net Profit} = -8$$

Motivation

- Cheaper than vanilla call since payoff is eliminated if barrier is hit.
- Suitable for moderate upside views below the barrier.

CRR Binomial Tree Recap

- Constraint: $u = \frac{1}{d}$.
- Second moment matching:
$$e^{(2r+\sigma^2)\Delta t} = pu^2 + (1-p)d^2.$$
- First moment matching:
$$p = \frac{e^{r\Delta t} - d}{u - d}.$$

Pricing Knock-Out Barrier Options

- At each node, check barrier condition.
- If barrier is triggered:
$$V = 0.$$
- Otherwise, continuation value:
$$V = e^{-r\Delta t}(pV_{\text{up}} + (1-p)V_{\text{down}}).$$
- Terminal payoff (if not knocked out):
$$\max(S-K,0)\ \text{(Call)}, \qquad \max(K-S,0)\ \text{(Put)}.$$

Alternative Binomial Tree Models

Jarrow–Rudd Model

- Equal probabilities (not risk-neutral): $p = \frac{1}{2}$.
- Parameters:
$$u = e^{(r-\frac{1}{2}\sigma^2)\Delta t + \sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}}, \quad d = e^{(r-\frac{1}{2}\sigma^2)\Delta t - \sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}}.$$

Tian Binomial Model

- Matches first three moments.
- Parameters:
$$p = \frac{e^{r\Delta t} - d}{u - d},$$
$$u = e^{(r-\frac{1}{2}\sigma^2)\Delta t + \sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}}, \quad d = e^{(r-\frac{1}{2}\sigma^2)\Delta t - \sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}}.$$

Options with Continuous Dividend Yield

- Continuous dividend yield at rate q:
$$1 \text{ unit at } t=0 \ \longrightarrow\ e^{qT} \text{ units at } T.$$
- Replicating portfolio at T:
$$\delta S_T e^{qT} + e^{rT}(V_0 - \delta S_0).$$
- Replication equations:
$$\begin{cases} \delta S_u e^{qT} + e^{rT}(V_0 - \delta S_0) = V_u, \\ \delta S_d e^{qT} + e^{rT}(V_0 - \delta S_0) = V_d. \end{cases}$$
- Solution:
$$\delta = e^{-qT}\frac{V_u - V_d}{S_u - S_d}, \qquad V_0 = e^{-rT}(pV_u + (1-p)V_d),$$
$$p = \frac{S_0 e^{(r-q)T} - S_d}{S_u - S_d}.$$

Black–Scholes and CRR Tree Models

- Without dividends:
$$\frac{dS_t}{S_t} = r\,dt + \sigma\,dW_t.$$
- With continuous dividend yield q:
$$\frac{dS_t}{S_t} = (r-q)\,dt + \sigma\,dW_t.$$
- Second moment matching:
$$\mathbb{E}[S_T^2] = e^{2(r-q)T + \sigma^2 T} = pu^2 + (1-p)d^2.$$
- CRR constraints ($u = 1/d$):
$$u = \frac{b + \sqrt{b^2-4}}{2}, \quad d = \frac{b - \sqrt{b^2-4}}{2},$$
$$b = e^{(r-q)T + \sigma^2 T} + e^{-(r-q)T}.$$

Path-Dependent Options in Trees

- American options: assume not exercised prior to current node.
- Barrier Knock-Out (KO): assume not knocked out yet.
- Other examples:
  - Knock-In (KI): activates only if barrier is hit,
  - Asian options: depend on average price history.

Barrier Options: KO vs KI

- **KO**: option becomes worthless if barrier is breached.
- **KI**: option becomes active only after barrier is breached.
- KO tree: track validity only.
- KI tree: track two states:
  - Barrier not triggered,
  - Barrier already triggered.

KIKO Parity

- KI and KO exhaust all barrier scenarios.
- Pricing identity:
$$\text{KI} = \text{Underlying payoff} - \text{KO}.$$
- Ensures arbitrage-free pricing and numerical stability.

Pricing Knock-In Options on Trees

- Two states at node (i,j):
$$V_{i,j}[0] \text{ (not triggered)}, \quad V_{i,j}[1] \text{ (triggered)}.$$
- Transition:
$$V_{i,j}[0] = \begin{cases} pV_{i+1,j}[0] + (1-p)V_{i+1,j+1}[0], & \text{no hit}, \\ pV_{i+1,j}[1] + (1-p)V_{i+1,j+1}[1], & \text{hit}, \end{cases}$$
$$V_{i,j}[1] = pV_{i+1,j}[1] + (1-p)V_{i+1,j+1}[1].$$

ValueAtNode Function

- Node value represented as a vector:
$$V_{i,j} = \begin{pmatrix} V_{i,j}[0] \\ V_{i,j}[1] \end{pmatrix} = f(\mathbb{E}^{\mathbb{Q}}[V_{i+1,j}]).$$
- Same logic as standard trees, but with vector-valued continuation.

Asian Options with Trees

- Payoff depends on average price $\bar{S}$:
$$\bar{S} = \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n} S_{T_i}.$$
- Asian call payoff:
$$\max(\bar{S} - K, 0).$$
- Decomposition at final fixing:
$$\bar{S} = \frac{1}{n}((n-1)A + S_{T_n}), \quad \tilde{K} = nK - (n-1)A.$$
- Auxiliary state: accumulated average A.
- Tree algorithm:
  - Discretize possible A values,
  - Backward induction for each A_i,
  - Node values returned as vectors.

Handling Intermediate and Fixing Dates (Asian Options)

Between Fixing Dates (T_{i-1}, T_i)

- The accumulated average A does not change,
- Node values equal continuation values.

At Fixing Dates T_i

The accumulated average is updated using the stock price S:
$$\widehat{A} = \frac{A \cdot i + S}{i+1}.$$

Interpolation of the Accumulated Average

Since $\widehat{A}$ may not lie on the grid $\{A_1, A_2, \ldots, A_m\}$, we apply linear interpolation.
Find j such that $\widehat{A} \in [A_j, A_{j+1}]$, and compute
$$V(\widehat{A}) = \frac{\widehat{A} - A_j}{A_{j+1} - A_j} V_{j+1} + \frac{A_{j+1} - \widehat{A}}{A_{j+1} - A_j} V_j,$$
where V_j, V_{j+1} are continuation values.

Additive Binomial Tree

- Use log-price as state variable: $X = \ln S$.
- Define increments:
$$u_x = \ln u, \qquad d_x = \ln d.$$

One-step dynamics (in X)
$$X_u = X_0 + \ln u = X_0 + u_x, \qquad X_d = X_0 + \ln d = X_0 + d_x,$$
with probabilities p and $1-p$ over one step Δt.

Calibration by matching moments

First moment

Black–Scholes solution for X:
$$X = X_0 + \left(r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)\Delta t + \sigma W_{\Delta t}.$$
$$\mathbb{E}[X] = X_0 + \left(r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)\Delta t.$$
In the binomial model,
$$\mathbb{E}[X] = X_0 + pu_x + (1-p)d_x = X_0 + \left(r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)\Delta t. \tag{10}$$
Equivalently,
$$pu_x + (1-p)d_x = \left(r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)\Delta t \implies p = \frac{\left(r - \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)\Delta t - d_x}{u_x - d_x}.$$

Second moment
$$\mathbb{E}[X^2] = p(X_0 + u_x)^2 + (1-p)(X_0 + d_x)^2$$
Expanding:
$$\mathbb{E}[X^2] = X_0^2 + 2pX_0u_x + 2(1-p)X_0d_x + pu_x^2 + (1-p)d_x^2$$
Group terms:
$$\mathbb{E}[X^2] = X_0^2 + 2X_0(pu_x + (1-p)d_x) + pu_x^2 + (1-p)d_x^2. \tag{15}$$
Black–Scholes second moment:
$$X_0^2 + 2X_0\left(r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)\Delta t + \left(r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)^2\Delta t^2 + \sigma^2\,\mathbb{E}[W_{\Delta t}^2], \tag{16}$$
with
$$\mathbb{E}[W_{\Delta t}^2] = \Delta t.$$
Matching yields:
$$pu_x^2 + (1-p)d_x^2 - \left(r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)^2\Delta t^2 = \sigma^2\Delta t. \tag{17}$$

CRR assumption
$$u_x = -d_x.$$

Convenient parameterization

Let
$$u_x = -d_x = \Delta x.$$
By CRR and (17):
$$\Delta x^2 = \sigma^2\Delta t + \left((r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2)\Delta t\right)^2,$$
so
$$\Delta x = \sqrt{\sigma^2\Delta t + \left((r - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2)\Delta t\right)^2} \approx \sigma\sqrt{\Delta t} \qquad \text{when } \Delta t \to 0.$$
Also,
$$p = \frac{\left(r - \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)\Delta t - d_x}{u_x - d_x} = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{r - \sigma^2/2}{2\sigma}\sqrt{\Delta t}.$$

Multi-Dimensional Binomial Method

Spread Option

A spread option gives payoff
$$[S_1(T) - S_2(T)]_+.$$
Assume both assets follow Black–Scholes with correlated Brownian motions:
$$\frac{dS_1}{S_1} = (r - q_1)dt + \sigma_1\,dW_1 \qquad \frac{dS_2}{S_2} = (r - q_2)dt + \sigma_2\,dW_2$$
and correlation
$$\rho\,dt = dW_1\,dW_2. \tag{24}$$

Log-state dynamics

Using the additive tree, define
$$x_1 = \ln S_1, \qquad x_2 = \ln S_2.$$
By Itô's lemma:
$$\begin{cases} dx_1 = \left(r - q_1 - \frac{1}{2}\sigma_1^2\right)dt + \sigma_1\,dW_1, \\ dx_2 = \left(r - q_2 - \frac{1}{2}\sigma_2^2\right)dt + \sigma_2\,dW_2. \end{cases} \tag{25}$$

Four-branch step (equal up/down jump sizes)

Choose equal up and down jump sizes:
$$\Delta x_1 = u_{x_1}, \qquad \Delta x_2 = u_{x_2}.$$
Each step has four outcomes with probabilities $p_{uu}, p_{ud}, p_{du}, p_{dd}$:
$$\begin{aligned} p_{uu}&: \quad (x_1 + \Delta x_1,\ x_2 + \Delta x_2), \\ p_{ud}&: \quad (x_1 + \Delta x_1,\ x_2 - \Delta x_2), \\ p_{du}&: \quad (x_1 - \Delta x_1,\ x_2 + \Delta x_2), \\ p_{dd}&: \quad (x_1 - \Delta x_1,\ x_2 - \Delta x_2). \end{aligned}$$

Calibration

Denote
$$v_1 = r - q_1 - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma_1^2, \qquad v_2 = r - q_2 - \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma_2^2.$$
Then
$$\begin{cases} dx_1 = v_1\,dt + \sigma_1\,dW_1, \\ dx_2 = v_2\,dt + \sigma_2\,dW_2. \end{cases}$$
So
$$\mathbb{E}[dx_1] = v_1\Delta t, \qquad \mathbb{E}[dx_2] = v_2\Delta t,$$
$$\mathrm{Var}[dx_1] = \sigma_1^2\Delta t, \qquad \mathrm{Var}[dx_2] = \sigma_2^2\Delta t, \qquad \mathrm{Cov}[dx_1, dx_2] = \rho\sigma_1\sigma_2\Delta t.$$
In the binomial model,
$$\mathbb{E}[dx_1] = (p_{uu} + p_{ud})\Delta x_1 - (p_{du} + p_{dd})\Delta x_1,$$
$$\mathrm{Var}[dx_1] = (p_{uu} + p_{ud})\Delta x_1^2 + (p_{du} + p_{dd})\Delta x_1^2 - \left(\mathbb{E}[dx_1]\right)^2 \approx (p_{uu} + p_{ud})\Delta x_1^2 + (p_{du} + p_{dd})\Delta x_1^2 \quad (\Delta t \text{ is very small}),$$
$$\mathrm{Cov}[dx_1, dx_2] = (p_{uu} - p_{ud} - p_{du} + p_{dd})\Delta x_1\Delta x_2.$$

Matching system

$$\begin{cases} \mathbb{E}[dx_1] = (p_{uu} + p_{ud})\Delta x_1 - (p_{du} + p_{dd})\Delta x_1 = v_1 \Delta t, \\ \mathbb{E}[dx_2] = (p_{uu} + p_{du})\Delta x_2 - (p_{ud} + p_{dd})\Delta x_2 = v_2 \Delta t, \\ \mathrm{Var}[dx_1] = (p_{uu} + p_{ud})\Delta x_1^2 + (p_{du} + p_{dd})\Delta x_1^2 = \sigma_1^2 \Delta t + (v_1 \Delta t)^2 \approx \sigma_1^2 \Delta t, \\ \mathrm{Var}[dx_2] = (p_{uu} + p_{du})\Delta x_2^2 + (p_{ud} + p_{dd})\Delta x_2^2 = \sigma_2^2 \Delta t + (v_2 \Delta t)^2 \approx \sigma_2^2 \Delta t, \\ (p_{uu} - p_{ud} - p_{du} + p_{dd})\Delta x_1 \Delta x_2 = \rho \sigma_1 \sigma_2 \Delta t, \\ p_{uu} + p_{ud} + p_{du} + p_{dd} = 1. \end{cases}$$

Solution (model parameters)

$$\Delta x_1 = \sigma_1 \sqrt{\Delta t}, \qquad \Delta x_2 = \sigma_2 \sqrt{\Delta t},$$

$$\begin{cases} p_{uu} = \dfrac{1}{4} \dfrac{\Delta x_1 \Delta x_2 + \Delta x_2 v_1 \Delta t + \Delta x_1 v_2 \Delta t + \rho \sigma_1 \sigma_2 \Delta t}{\Delta x_1 \Delta x_2}, \\ p_{ud} = \dfrac{1}{4} \dfrac{\Delta x_1 \Delta x_2 + \Delta x_2 v_1 \Delta t - \Delta x_1 v_2 \Delta t - \rho \sigma_1 \sigma_2 \Delta t}{\Delta x_1 \Delta x_2}, \\ p_{du} = \dfrac{1}{4} \dfrac{\Delta x_1 \Delta x_2 - \Delta x_2 v_1 \Delta t + \Delta x_1 v_2 \Delta t - \rho \sigma_1 \sigma_2 \Delta t}{\Delta x_1 \Delta x_2}, \\ p_{dd} = \dfrac{1}{4} \dfrac{\Delta x_1 \Delta x_2 - \Delta x_2 v_1 \Delta t - \Delta x_1 v_2 \Delta t + \rho \sigma_1 \sigma_2 \Delta t}{\Delta x_1 \Delta x_2}. \end{cases}$$

Multi-dimensional binomial tree: node definition and pricing
For each node (k, i, j):
- k: time step (starting at $t = 0$),
- i: number of downward moves of asset 1 up to time k,
- j: number of downward moves of asset 2 up to time k.

For asset 1, upward moves are $k - i$, so cumulative change:

$$(k - i)\Delta x_1 - i\Delta x_1 = (k - 2i)\Delta x_1,$$

and similarly for asset 2: $(k - 2j)\Delta x_2$.
Thus prices at node (k, i, j) are

$$S_{1,k,i,j} = S_1 e^{(k-2i)\Delta x_1}, \qquad S_{2,k,i,j} = S_2 e^{(k-2j)\Delta x_2}.$$

Terminal payoff:

$$V = \max(0, S_1 - S_2).$$

Backward induction:

$$V_{k,i,j} = e^{-r\Delta t}\left[p_{uu} V_{k+1,i,j} + p_{ud} V_{k+1,i,j+1} + p_{du} V_{k+1,i+1,j} + p_{dd} V_{k+1,i+1,j+1}\right].$$

Analytic solution for spread option (Margrabe formula)
Price via change of numeraire; express payoff in units of S_2:

$$\left[\frac{S_1(T)}{S_2(T)} - 1\right]_+.$$

Under the dollar measure, the volatility of $\frac{S_1(T)}{S_2(T)}$ is

$$\sigma = \sqrt{\sigma_1^2 + \sigma_2^2 - 2\rho\sigma_1\sigma_2}.$$

Trinomial Tree Model
- The trinomial tree is an extension of the binomial tree model.
- At each time step, the underlying asset has three possible movements:
  - Upward movement: price multiplies by $u > 1$ with probability p_u,
  - Middle movement: price remains unchanged with probability p_m,
  - Downward movement: price multiplies by $d < 1$ with probability p_d.
- Probabilities satisfy:

$$p_u + p_m + p_d = 1.$$

Calibration of the Trinomial Tree
To calibrate parameters (u, d, p_u, p_m, p_d), we match moments of the discrete model to the continuous-time model.
- First moment (mean):

$$e^{\mu\Delta t} = p_u u + p_m + p_d d.$$

- Second moment:

$$e^{2\mu\Delta t + \sigma^2 \Delta t} = p_u u^2 + p_m + p_d d^2.$$

- Symmetry assumption:

$$u = \frac{1}{d}.$$

Underdetermined System
- There are 5 unknowns and only 4 equations.
- This leads to infinitely many solutions.
- To resolve this, introduce a tunable parameter λ controlling jump size.

Choice of Jump Sizes

$$u = e^{\lambda\sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}}, \qquad d = e^{-\lambda\sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}}.$$

Resulting Probabilities

$$p_u = \frac{1}{2\lambda^2} + \frac{\mu - \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2}{2\lambda\sigma}\sqrt{\Delta t},$$
$$p_d = \frac{1}{2\lambda^2} - \frac{\mu - \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2}{2\lambda\sigma}\sqrt{\Delta t},$$
$$p_m = 1 - p_u - p_d.$$

Example Choice
- Let $\lambda = \sqrt{3}$. Then:

$$u = e^{\sqrt{3\Delta t}}, \qquad d = e^{-\sqrt{3\Delta t}}.$$

- Corresponding probabilities:

$$p_u = \frac{1}{6} + \frac{\mu - \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2}{\sqrt{12}\sigma}\sqrt{\Delta t}, \quad p_d = \frac{1}{6} - \frac{\mu - \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2}{\sqrt{12}\sigma}\sqrt{\Delta t}, \quad p_m = \frac{2}{3}.$$

Remarks
- Trinomial trees often provide faster convergence than binomial trees.
- As $\Delta t \to 0$, the trinomial tree converges to the Black–Scholes model.

Lecture 4

From Constant to Implied Volatility
- **Black–Scholes assumption: constant volatility**

$$\frac{dS}{S} = (r - q)\,dt + \sigma\,dW$$

  - r: risk-free rate, q: dividend yield, σ: constant volatility.
  - This simplifies the mathematics and allows for a closed-form solution.
  - The volatility parameter σ must be specified by the user.
- **Market reality: volatility is not constant**
  - Volatility changes over time (volatility clustering).
  - Options with different strikes and maturities trade at different volatilities.
- **Implied volatility (IV): reverse of Black–Scholes**
  - Observe the market price of the option.
  - Solve for the σ that makes the Black–Scholes price match the market price.

Implied Volatility: Definition and Properties
- IV is obtained by **inverting** an option pricing model (e.g., Black–Scholes):
  - Input: observed market option price
  - Output: volatility that reproduces this price in the model
- **Key properties**
  - IV is model-derived, not directly observed.
  - IV is forward-looking (unlike historical volatility).
  - IV is not constant in practice.
- IV varies across:
  - Strike (moneyness), Maturity, Time (sentiment and events).
- **Interpretation:** market replaces constant-σ with IV to better reflect expectations.

Implied Volatility: Practical Meaning and Uses
- **Link to Black–Scholes**
  - Black–Scholes gives option price as a function of volatility.
  - Market practice reverses this relation to obtain implied volatility.
  - IV is the volatility input that makes the BS price match the market price.
  - Hence BS is a quoting and calibration tool, not only a pricing formula.
- **Why practitioners work with IV instead of price**
  - Option prices move mechanically with the spot price.
  - IV is more stable and comparable across contracts.
  - IV provides a normalized scale across strikes and maturities.
- **How traders use IV**
  - Evaluate whether an option is relatively expensive/cheap (vs. model).
  - Trade volatility directly (low-IV buy / high-IV sell strategies).
  - Compute Greeks and manage hedging risk consistently.
- **Result:** options are often quoted and managed in implied-volatility space.

Low vs. High Implied Volatility
- Options with higher IV are priced higher due to greater uncertainty.

Implied Volatility Surface
- In practice, vanilla options (standard calls/puts) are highly liquid and actively traded.
- Market participants agree on prices for common maturities and strikes, forming an **implied volatility surface**.
- Market makers must handle requests across a wide range of strikes and maturities.
- Directly managing option prices is impractical because:
  - Prices depend dynamically on the spot price, which fluctuates in real time.
  - Instead, participants quote IV, e.g. "105 call, 3-month, at 32% vol" rather than "price = 2.73".
- The IV surface allows traders to:
  - Interpolate/extrapolate prices for non-standard options,
  - Adjust for market conditions without recalibrating the entire pricing model.

Aspect	Low IV	High IV
Market expectation	Small moves	Large moves
Sentiment	Calm / Bullish	Fearful / Bearish
Risk	Lower	Higher
Option price	Lower	Higher

Black–Scholes Model: A Handy Tool for Option Pricing

- Directly managing option prices is challenging due to dependence on the underlying spot price.
- Black–Scholes provides a mathematical framework to compute option prices from key parameters:

$$V_{\text{call}}(K, S, \sigma, T, r) = S\,N(d_+) - e^{-rT} K\,N(d_-)$$

where

$$d_\pm = \frac{\ln\left(\frac{S}{K}\right) + (r-q)T \pm \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2 T}{\sigma\sqrt{T}}.$$

- with S current asset price, K strike, σ volatility, T time to maturity, r risk-free rate, q dividend yield, and $N(\cdot)$ the standard normal CDF.

Implied Volatility as an Implicit Function

- View Black–Scholes as a function from volatility σ to call price V:

$$f_{\{S,r,q,K,T\}}(\sigma) = V.$$

- Implied volatility is obtained by inverting this function:

$$\sigma = f^{-1}(V).$$

- **Key property:** the call price is monotone in σ:
  - When σ increases, V increases (higher volatility raises time value).
  - This holds as long as $T \geq 0$ (time remaining before expiration).
- However, f^{-1} has no closed form $\Rightarrow$ IV is an **implicit** function of σ.
- We therefore resort to a **root finding algorithm** to back out σ from market prices.

Root Finding: Solving $f(x) = 0$

- Given a function f, the goal is to determine the value(s) of x such that

$$f(x) = 0.$$

- This can arise in one-dimensional or multi-dimensional (N-dimensional) settings.
- **One-dimensional problem** ($f : \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$)
  - Easier to solve due to well-developed robust numerical algorithms.
  - Typically requires only function evaluations or derivatives to iteratively converge.
- **N-dimensional problem** ($f : \mathbb{R}^N \to \mathbb{R}$)
  - More challenging due to complex function landscapes.
  - Structure, curvature, and sensitivity often matter for efficient convergence.
- In implied volatility computation, we mainly deal with the **one-dimensional** case.

Bracketing the root: Ensuring the root is contained

Most fast root finding algorithms require an initial interval (bracket) that contains the root.
A bracket is an interval $[a, b]$ where $f(a)$ and $f(b)$ have opposite signs:

$$f(a) \cdot f(b) \leq 0.$$

This ensures that a root exists within the interval, provided that f is continuous.

How to Bracket the Root?

- Start with an initial interval that is likely to contain the root.
- If the initial interval does not satisfy $f(a) \cdot f(b) \leq 0$, adjust it by:
  - Expanding outward to search for a sign change,
  - Shrinking inward, if the function exhibits a known behavior in a smaller range.
- Once a valid bracket is found, iterative methods can be applied to refine the root estimate.

Root Bracketing Algorithm

Algorithm 1: RootBracketing(f, a, b, maxIter, factor)

- For $k = 1$ to maxIter:
- If $f(a)f(b) < 0$, return (a, b).
- If $|f(a)| < |f(b)|$, update

$$a \leftarrow a + \text{factor}\,(a - b).$$

- Else update

$$b \leftarrow b + \text{factor}\,(b - a).$$

If factor > 0, the algorithm searches outward.
If $-1 <$ factor < 0, the algorithm searches inward.

Root finding algorithms

Now we are equipped with a root bracketing algorithm.

Root finding

Given a function f, find the x such that

$$f(x) = 0.$$

Commonly used root finding algorithms:

- Bisection method
- Secant method
- False position method
- Brent's method
- Newton method

Bisection Method

Start with $[a, b]$ that brackets the root, cut it by half, then see which half contains the root.

Algorithm 2: rfbisect(f, a, b, tol)
Require: $f(a)f(b) < 0$, f is continuous, tolerance tol.

- while $(b - a)/2 >$ tol do
- $c \leftarrow \dfrac{a+b}{2}$
- if $f(c) = 0$ then return c
- else if $f(a)f(c) < 0$ then $b \leftarrow c$
- else $a \leftarrow c$

Bisection Method: Pro and Con

Pros

- Simple and easy to implement
- Only requires function evaluations, no derivatives needed
- Theoretically guaranteed to converge
- Robustness: if the interval contains more than one root, bisection will find one of them

Cons

- Slow convergence with only linear rate

$$\epsilon_n = |c_n - r| \leq \frac{b_n - a_n}{2}, \qquad c_n = \frac{a_n + b_n}{2}$$

Considering worst case:

$$\epsilon_{n+1} = \frac{1}{2}\epsilon_n.$$

Secant method

The secant method is motivated by the need for a faster alternative to bisection by utilizing the slope information of the function, yet does not require derivatives like Newton's method.
Consider a first-order Taylor expansion around a root x:

$$f(x) \approx f(x_n) + f'(x_n)(x - x_n).$$

Since $f(x) = 0$, we have

$$0 \approx f(x_n) + f'(x_n)(x - x_n) \quad \Rightarrow \quad x \approx x_n - \frac{f(x_n)}{f'(x_n)}.$$

Replace the derivative by the first-order difference:

$$f'(x_n) \approx \frac{f(x_n) - f(x_{n-1})}{x_n - x_{n-1}}.$$

Secant Method Iteration

The iterative scheme is:

$$x_{n+1} = x_n - f(x_n)\frac{x_n - x_{n-1}}{f(x_n) - f(x_{n-1})}.$$

Algorithm 3: rfsecant(f, x_1, x_2, tol)
Require: f is continuous, tolerance tol.

Secant Method: Pro and Con

Pros

- Open bracket method: does not require a bracket containing the root
- Faster convergence than bisection
- Superlinear convergence rate with order ≈ 1.62 (Golden Ratio)
- Works very well for nearly linear function

Cons

- Does not always converge, especially if:
  - The function has discontinuities or steep curvature
  - The denominator $f(x_{n+1}) - f(x_n)$ approaches zero
- Can fail without a proper stopping criterion
- Solution: implement a maximum iteration limit (maxIter)

False Position Method

The **false position method** (regula falsi) is a combination of the **bisection** and **secant** methods.

- Start with an interval $[a, b]$ that brackets the root.
- Draw a secant line through $(a, f(a))$ and $(b, f(b))$.
- Find its x-intercept at c.
- Update a or b to maintain the bracketed root.

Algorithm 4: `rffalsi`(f, a, b, tol)

- Require: $f(a)f(b) < 0$, f continuous
- While $b - a >$ tol:
- Compute

$$c \leftarrow \frac{af(b) - bf(a)}{f(b) - f(a)}.$$

- If $f(c) = 0$, return c.
- Else if $f(a)f(c) < 0$, set $b \leftarrow c$.
- Else set $a \leftarrow c$.

False Position Method: Pro and Con

Pros

- More robust than the secant method (maintains a bracket).
- Guaranteed to find a root if one exists.
- Often faster than bisection.

Cons

- Can converge slowly in certain cases.
- May behave similarly to bisection if one endpoint remains fixed.

Root Finding Algorithms: Considerations

Numerical methods are sensitive to:

- Initial values and assumptions,
- Problem characteristics,
- Tolerance settings,
- Round-off and truncation errors.

Before applying a root-finding algorithm, the problem must be analyzed carefully.

Brent's Method

The bisection method is robust but converges linearly. Secant and false-position methods converge faster but may fail. Brent's method is an adaptive hybrid strategy:

- Uses secant-like steps when they perform well,
- Falls back to bisection when needed,
- Ensures robustness while maintaining fast convergence.

Brent's method combines bisection, secant, inverse quadratic interpolation.

Inverse Quadratic Interpolation

This method improves convergence by fitting a quadratic function through the last three iteration points.

- Given three points
$$(x_0, f(x_0)),\ (x_1, f(x_1)),\ (x_2, f(x_2)),$$
fit
$$q(y) = ay^2 + by + c.$$
- Solve for the next estimate by taking
$$x = q(0).$$

Newton Method

Newton's method starts with one point instead of two.

The iteration scheme is:
$$x_{n+1} = x_n - \frac{f(x_n)}{f'(x_n)}.$$

At each iteration, it updates using the intercept of the tangent line with the x-axis.

Convergence Rate of Newton Method

Newton's method achieves **quadratic convergence** under suitable conditions.

Define
$$g(x) = x - \frac{f(x)}{f'(x)}.$$

Then Newton iteration is
$$x_{n+1} = g(x_n).$$

Define the error $e_n = x_n - r$. By Taylor expansion:
$$g(x_n) = g(r + e_n) = g(r) + g'(r)e_n + O(e_n^2).$$

Note that
$$g(r) = r, \qquad g'(r) = \frac{f(r)f''(r)}{f'(r)^2} = 0.$$

Hence
$$e_{n+1} = \frac{g''(\eta)}{2} e_n^2.$$

Newton Method: Potential Issues: Newton's method requires a good initial guess. Poor initialization may lead to divergence. The remedy is to mix Newton's method with bisection for stability.

Newton Method in Multi-Dimension Space

Newton's method can be extended to solve a system of non-linear equations:
$$f(x) = 0 \quad \to \quad \{f_i(x) = 0,\ 1 \le i \le N\}, \qquad x \in \mathbb{R}^N.$$

Update Rule in Multiple Dimensions

The update rule in multiple dimensions is given by:
$$x_{n+1} = x_n - J^{-1}(x_n)f(x_n).$$

- x_n is the current approximation of the root.
- $J(x)$ is the **Jacobian matrix**, containing first-order partial derivatives:
$$J_{ij} = \frac{\partial f_i}{\partial x_j}.$$

Computational Challenges

Evaluating and inverting $J(x)$ can be computationally expensive.

Instead of directly inverting $J(x)$, one typically solves the linear system:
$$J(x_n)\Delta x = -f(x_n), \qquad \Delta x = x_{n+1} - x_n.$$

Convergence Issues

Newton's method in high dimensions can face convergence difficulties due to:

- Complex nonlinear landscapes,
- Sensitivity to initialization,
- Expensive Jacobian computations.

Root Finding vs. Optimization in Quantitative Finance

In quantitative finance, we rarely encounter direct N-dimensional root-finding problems:
$$f(x) = 0, \qquad x \in \mathbb{R}^N.$$

This is because financial models typically do not require solving general nonlinear systems of equations without additional structure.

Optimization is More Common Instead, we frequently deal with:

- Minimization or maximization problems, where the goal is to optimize an objective function.
- Finding stationary points where the gradient satisfies:
$$\nabla g(x) = 0,$$

which is mathematically equivalent to solving a root-finding problem for the gradient. Financial models impose constraints on gradients, making them predictable and solvable with structured numerical techniques.

Lecture 5

Implied Volatility and Surface Construction

Converting Option Prices to Implied Volatility

We can now compute the implied volatility corresponding to a given option price.

In practice, options are often quoted using implied volatility instead of price because:

- implied volatility is less sensitive to changes than spot price,
- implied volatility is changing less frequently than spot price.

Discrete Data from Market Observations

Assume we have a discrete set of liquid maturities, such as 1W, 2W, 1M, 2M, 6M, 1Y, etc.

For each maturity (or pillar), market data provides a set of strike vs. option price tuples:
$$(k_i, C_i), \qquad i = 1, 2, \ldots, N.$$

Using the root-finding algorithm, we convert these into strike vs. implied volatility tuples:
$$(k_i, \sigma_i), \qquad i = 1, 2, \ldots, N.$$

Constructing the Implied Volatility Surface

To quote or price vanilla options at any arbitrary strike and maturity, we need to construct an implied volatility surface. It requires:

- **Interpolation**: estimating implied volatilities between known market points,
- **Extrapolation**: extending the volatility surface beyond observed strikes or maturities.

A well-constructed volatility surface allows traders and risk managers to:

- Price options consistently across different strikes and expirations,
- Identify market trends and arbitrage opportunities,
- Calibrate pricing models for hedging and risk management.

Volatility Smile Interpolation

Volatility Smile

The function $k \mapsto \sigma$ for a fixed maturity describes how implied volatility changes with strike price.

This function is often referred to as the **volatility smile** due to its typical convex shape.

Understanding the Pattern

Higher implied volatility for deep in-the-money (ITM) and out-of-the-money (OTM) strikes:

- Options far from the current stock price tend to have higher implied volatility.
- Deep ITM and OTM options have lower liquidity and are more sensitive to large price swings.
- Market participants demand higher volatility premiums to compensate for uncertainty.

Lower implied volatility near at-the-money (ATM):

- ATM options typically exhibit the lowest implied volatility.
- These options are the most liquid and actively traded.
- Their implied volatility is stabilized by market forces.

Starting with Linear Interpolation

Given sample points (x_i, y_i), $i \in [0, 1, \ldots, N]$, linear interpolation constructs a piecewise linear function $L(x)$ of the form
$$L(x) = L_i(x), \qquad x \in [x_i, x_{i+1}], \quad i = 0, \ldots, N-1.$$

Such that:

- Each L_i is a linear polynomial,
- $L_0(x_0) = y_0$, $L_{N-1}(x_N) = y_N$,
- $L_i(x_{i+1}) = L_{i+1}(x_{i+1}) = y_{i+1}$.

The linear function is uniquely determined by:
$$L_i(x_i) = y_i, \qquad L_i(x_{i+1}) = y_{i+1}.$$

Let $h_i = x_{i+1} - x_i$, then for $x \in [x_i, x_{i+1}]$:
$$L_i(x) = y_{i+1}\frac{x - x_i}{h_i} + y_i\frac{x_{i+1} - x}{h_i}.$$

Cubic Spline Interpolation

Given sample points (x_i, y_i), cubic spline interpolation constructs a C^2 piecewise cubic polynomial $S(x)$ of the form
$$S(x) = S_i(x), \qquad x \in [x_i, x_{i+1}], \quad i = 0, \ldots, N-1.$$

Such that:

- Each S_i is a cubic polynomial,
- $S_0(x_0) = y_0$, $S_{N-1}(x_N) = y_N$,
- $S_i(x_{i+1}) = S_{i+1}(x_{i+1}) = y_{i+1}$,
- $S_i'(x_{i+1}) = S_{i+1}'(x_{i+1})$,
- $S_i''(x_{i+1}) = S_{i+1}''(x_{i+1})$.

Assume the second derivatives at each node are:
$$S''(x_j) = M_j, \qquad 0 \le j \le N.$$

Then for each S_i:
$$S_i(x_i) = y_i, \quad S_i(x_{i+1}) = y_{i+1}, \quad S_i''(x_i) = M_i, \quad S_i''(x_{i+1}) = M_{i+1}.$$

The four conditions determine a unique cubic polynomial. Let $h_i = x_{i+1} - x_i$:
$$S_i(x) = \frac{M_{i+1}}{6h_i}(x - x_i)^3 + \frac{M_i}{6h_i}(x_{i+1} - x)^3 + \left(y_i - \frac{M_i h_i^2}{6}\right)\frac{x_{i+1} - x}{h_i} + \left(y_{i+1} - \frac{M_{i+1}h_i^2}{6}\right)\frac{x - x_i}{h_i}.$$

Recall S has continuous first derivatives:
$$S_i'(x_{i+1}) = S_{i+1}'(x_{i+1}).$$

Setting this yields the standard tridiagonal system:

$$h_{i-1}M_{i-1} + 2(h_{i-1} + h_i)M_i + h_i M_{i+1} = 6\left(\frac{y_{i+1} - y_i}{h_i} - \frac{y_i - y_{i-1}}{h_{i-1}}\right), \qquad 1 \le i \le N-2.$$

Additional boundary conditions:

- Natural spline:

$$M_0 = 0, \qquad M_{N+1} = 0.$$

- Or impose boundary values on first derivatives:

$$S_0'(x_0) = p_0, \qquad S_{N-1}'(x_N) = p_1.$$

Cubic Spline Interpolation in our Application

We may impose clamped boundary conditions by setting y_0' and y_{N-1}' to 0. This ensures flattened volatility beyond the boundary.

Interpolation can be applied to either variance σ^2 or volatility σ.

No-Arbitrage Considerations

- Interpolated implied volatilities are not guaranteed to be arbitrage-free.
- This can be problematic in pegged currency markets where strict rules prevent arbitrage.

Time Interpolation in Implied Volatility

At each maturity, we have a volatility smile capturing the variation of implied volatility across strikes.

When evaluating options expiring between pillar dates, we must interpolate implied volatility across time to obtain a smooth volatility surface.

A common choice is **linear interpolation on total variance** σ^2 along the strike line. This ensures that variance increases with time, which is necessary to preserve calendar arbitrage constraints.

- For options with the same strike, longer maturity implies higher option value.
- Interpolating variance guarantees variance remains increasing, provided variance at the next pillar is higher than at the previous one.

Mathematical Formulation

We interpolate the total variance linearly in time:

$$v_t(K) = \frac{t_{i+1} - t}{t_{i+1} - t_i} v_{t_i}(K) + \frac{t - t_i}{t_{i+1} - t_i} v_{t_{i+1}}(K), \qquad v_t(K) = \sigma_t^2(K)\, t.$$

Implementation of Implied Volatility Surface

1. Interpolation Across Strike (Fixed Maturity)

For each maturity t_i:

- Market provides implied volatility at discrete strikes.
- Construct a smooth volatility smile using **cubic spline interpolation**:

$$\sigma_{t_i}(K) = S_{t_i}(K).$$

Purpose: smooth variation across strike and avoid unrealistic jumps in volatility.

2. Interpolation Across Time (Fixed Strike)

For a given strike K, volatility must be interpolated across maturities. We interpolate **total variance**, not volatility:

$$v(t, K) = \sigma(t, K)^2\, t.$$

Reason: total variance should increase with maturity to prevent calendar arbitrage.

Summary: Computing Implied Volatility at Strike K and Maturity t

- Step 1: For each market maturity t_i, construct cubic spline $S_{t_i}(K)$.
- Step 2: Locate surrounding maturities $t_i \le t \le t_{i+1}$.
- Step 3: Evaluate spline at strike K:

$$\sigma_{t_i}(K) = S_{t_i}(K), \qquad \sigma_{t_{i+1}}(K) = S_{t_{i+1}}(K).$$

- Step 4: Convert to total variance:

$$v_{t_i}(K) = \sigma_{t_i}(K)^2 t_i, \qquad v_{t_{i+1}}(K) = \sigma_{t_{i+1}}(K)^2 t_{i+1}.$$

- Step 5: Linear interpolation in time:

$$v_t(K) = \frac{t_{i+1} - t}{t_{i+1} - t_i} v_{t_i}(K) + \frac{t - t_i}{t_{i+1} - t_i} v_{t_{i+1}}(K).$$

- Step 6: Convert back to volatility:

$$\sigma_t(K) = \sqrt{\frac{v_t(K)}{t}}.$$

Market Variations in Volatility Quotes

- Some asset classes (commodities, equities, rates) provide option price quotes across strikes and maturities.
- Other markets, such as FX options, do not directly quote a full volatility surface.

Since FX markets do not provide implied volatilities for all strikes, an extra step is needed to map market quotes into surface inputs.

What are FX Options?

FX options give the right (but not obligation) to exchange a specified amount of one currency for another at a pre-agreed strike rate on or before maturity.

Key Features of FX Options

- Two interest rates: domestic and foreign.
- Underlying asset: exchange rate (currency pair).
- Premium payment typically in domestic currency.

How Option is Quoted in FX Options

In FX options, traders often summarize the volatility smile by quoting:

- **ATM volatility**: implied volatility of an option whose strike equals the forward exchange rate.
- **Risk Reversal (RR)**: measures skew of the implied volatility smile.
- **Butterfly (BF)**: measures smile curvature (fat-tailedness).

Quoting via ATM, RR, BF provides a compact way to negotiate, price, and hedge FX options.

FX Market Conventions: Spot

- FX spot rate: exchange rate at which two currencies can be exchanged immediately.
- In practice, FX spot transactions settle in 1 or 2 days ($T+1$ or $T+2$).
- This delay is called the **spot-lag**.

For simplicity, we ignore the spot-lag in this course.

FX Market Conventions: Moneyness

In FX options, the strike price K is expressed as an exchange rate.

Moneyness is determined by comparing strike K to forward price F:

$$F = Se^{(r_d - r_f)T},$$

where S is spot price and T is maturity.

- At-the-Money (ATM): $K = F$.
- In-the-Money (ITM): Call $K < F$, Put $K > F$.
- Out-of-the-Money (OTM): Call $K > F$, Put $K < F$.

FX Market Conventions: ATMVOL

ATMVOL refers to the implied volatility of an ATM option in FX markets.

Two common definitions:

- ATM Forward (ATM-FWD)
- ATM Delta-Neutral Straddle (ATM-DNS)

ATM Forward strike is set to the forward price:

$$K_{ATM} = F = Se^{\int_0^t (r_d(s) - r_f(s))ds}.$$

Since strike matches forward price, call and put have the same price (put-call parity).

FX Market Conventions: Delta

Delta measures sensitivity of an option price to changes in the underlying asset.

- Call options: Delta ranges from 0 to $+1$.
- Put options: Delta ranges from 0 to -1.

Key principle: an option can never react more strongly than owning the asset itself.

Delta for Black-Scholes Price (CALL)

The Black–Scholes price for a European FX call option is:

$$Call_{BS} = Se^{-r_f T} N(d_+) - Ke^{-r_d T} N(d_-),$$

with

$$d_\pm = \frac{\ln(F/K) \pm \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2 T}{\sigma\sqrt{T}}.$$

where:

- r_f: foreign risk-free rate,
- r_d: domestic risk-free rate,
- $F = Se^{(r_d - r_f)T}$: forward exchange rate.

The call delta is:

$$\Delta_{call}(\sigma, K, T, r_d, r_f) = \frac{\partial Call_{BS}}{\partial S} = e^{-r_f T} N(d_+).$$

Delta (PUT)

The Black–Scholes price for a European FX put option is:

$$Put_{BS} = Ke^{-r_d T} N(-d_-) - Se^{-r_f T} N(-d_+).$$

The put delta is:

$$\Delta_{put}(\sigma, K, T, r_d, r_f) = \frac{\partial Put_{BS}}{\partial S} = -e^{-r_f T} N(-d_+).$$

Forward delta (derivative w.r.t. forward price F) is:

$$\Delta_{call} = N(d_+), \qquad \Delta_{put} = -N(-d_+).$$

ATM Delta-Neutral Straddle (ATM-DNS)

A straddle consists of:

- Buying one call and one put,
- Same strike K and maturity T.

The ATM-DNS strike is defined by zero net delta:

$$\Delta_{call}(K_{DNS}) + \Delta_{put}(K_{DNS}) = 0.$$

Solving the delta-neutral condition gives:

$$K_{DNS} = Fe^{\frac{1}{2}\sigma_{ATM}^2 T}.$$

FX Market Convention — Our Use Case

In practice, FX markets often use:

- ATM forward convention,
- Forward delta instead of spot delta.

Forward delta ranges:

$$\Delta_{call} = N(d_+), \qquad \Delta_{put} = -N(-d_+).$$

Using Delta
Delta is fundamental in FX options trading:
- First risk to hedge,
- Standardized measure of moneyness.

FX options are quoted by delta levels Δ, e.g.

$$25\Delta \text{ Call.}$$

The strike K must be found by solving:

$$0.25 = \Delta_{call} = N(d_+), \qquad d_+ = \frac{\ln(F/K) + \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2 T}{\sigma\sqrt{T}}.$$

Market Strangle
A market strangle is:
- Buy one OTM call (higher strike),
- Buy one OTM put (lower strike).

It hedges large price moves in either direction.
Market Strangle Volatility Spread
In FX, strangles are quoted as a volatility spread relative to ATM:

$$\sigma^{\delta}_{ms}.$$

The OTM volatilities satisfy:

$$\frac{\sigma_c + \sigma_p}{2} = \sigma_{ATM} + \sigma^{\delta}_{ms},$$

where:
- σ_c: implied vol of OTM call,
- σ_p: implied vol of OTM put,
- σ_{ATM}: ATM implied vol.

Pricing the Strangle
Under Black–Scholes:

$$\text{Strangle price} = C(K_c, \sigma_c) + P(K_p, \sigma_p).$$

Market strangles constrain the curvature of the volatility smile:
- Expensive strangles $\rightarrow$ stronger convexity,
- Cheap strangles $\rightarrow$ flatter smile.

The strikes are determined by delta conditions:

$$\Delta_{call}(K_c, \sigma_{ATM} + \sigma_{\Delta_{ms}}) = \Delta,$$

$$\Delta_{put}(K_p, \sigma_{ATM} + \sigma_{\Delta_{ms}}) = -\Delta.$$

Link Between Market Strangle and Volatility Smile
- In a market strangle, traders rely on implied volatility to generate profits.
- The implied volatility curve follows a volatility smile:
  - Out-of-the-money (OTM) options have higher implied volatility,
  - Hence OTM calls and puts are more expensive.
- If the volatility smile is steep, strangles become more costly.
- If the smile is flatter, strangles are cheaper but profit potential is smaller.

Market Role of Strangles
- Constrains the volatility smile and surface shape.
- Measures smile convexity:

$$\text{greater strangle spread} \;\Rightarrow\; \text{more convex smile.}$$

-
Smile Strangle and Risk Reversal
Smile Strangle (Butterfly)
The smile strangle BF_Δ (butterfly spread) measures convexity:

$$BF_\Delta = \frac{1}{2}\left(\sigma_{\Delta_c} + \sigma_{\Delta_p}\right) - \sigma_{ATM}.$$

- Δ_c: delta level of the call option
- Δ_p: delta level of the put option
- Example: 25Δ smile strangle averages implied vols of 25Δ call/put minus ATM.

Risk Reversal
The risk reversal RR_Δ measures asymmetry (skewness):

$$RR_\Delta = \sigma_{\Delta_c} - \sigma_{\Delta_p}.$$

- Shows difference between implied vol of OTM calls and OTM puts.
- If $RR_\Delta > 0$, calls are more expensive (bullish skew).
- If $RR_\Delta < 0$, puts are more expensive (bearish skew).

The FX Volatility Marking Problems
In FX markets, implied volatility is quoted at specific delta levels rather than fixed strikes.
Given ATM volatility σ_{ATM}, smile strangles, and risk reversals, we solve:

$$\begin{cases} BF_\Delta = \frac{1}{2}(\sigma_{\Delta_c} + \sigma_{\Delta_p}) - \sigma_{ATM}, \\ RR_\Delta = \sigma_{\Delta_c} - \sigma_{\Delta_p}. \end{cases}$$

This yields:

$$\sigma_{\Delta_c} = \sigma_{ATM} + BF_\Delta + \frac{1}{2}RR_\Delta, \qquad \sigma_{\Delta_p} = \sigma_{ATM} + BF_\Delta - \frac{1}{2}RR_\Delta.$$

Converting Delta Quotes to Strike-Based Inputs
Market quotes are given as (Δ_i, σ_i) pairs, but we need strike-volatility pairs (K_i, σ_i).
Convert using:

$$\Delta_{call}(K_c, \sigma) = \Delta, \qquad \Delta_{put}(K_p, \sigma) = -\Delta.$$

Then K_i is found by solving these equations via root-finding.
Market Data Considerations
- Risk reversal RR is directly quoted.
- Smile strangle BF is not explicitly quoted: market provides only *market strangle* data.
- Challenge: construct the full implied volatility surface from ATM, RR, and strangles.

Market Strangle, Risk Reversal, and Surface Construction
- Risk reversal is observable in the raw market.
- Smile strangle is not directly observable; only market strangles are given.
- Key steps in volatility surface construction:
  - Collect bid-ask spreads for strangles and risk reversals across maturities.
  - Interpolate missing smile strangle data using spline or arbitrage-free methods.
  - Apply advanced volatility models to fit observed quotes.
  - Ensure no-arbitrage consistency with risk-neutral pricing.

How About Diffusion Models?
So far, we built an implied volatility surface to match vanilla option quotes.
However, Black–Scholes assumes constant volatility and cannot reproduce the full smile across strikes and maturities.
Need for an Advanced Model
- We are model-less: no full stochastic process for the underlying.
- Exotic and path-dependent options require richer models.
- Any advanced model must calibrate to the implied volatility surface.

Local Volatility Model
The local volatility model is a natural extension of Black–Scholes:
- Volatility depends on both time and underlying price.
- Designed to fit the implied volatility surface exactly.
- Provides a powerful framework for pricing exotic options.